SPORTS | Inspiration

SACHINISM AND THE IDEA OF INDIA: How sports shaped a legend, and can transform the country. Personal diary of an icon

SACHIN TENDULKAR *Cricket Legend*

MASTER CLASS

It's been almost a decade since Sachin Tendulkar hung up his boots after playing his 200th Test in November 2013, but watching him speak at the India Today Conclave reaffirmed that 'The Little Master' can still read the pulse of the game like none other.

From ways to ensure Test cricket remains the "No. 1 format" to suggesting a new avatar for the "monotonous" One Day Internationals (ODIs), Sachin kept everyone engaged with his insights. But as the legendary cricketer touched upon various facets of the game, what stood out was his impassioned appeal to strike a balance between batters and bowlers. Yes, the man who gave sleepless nights to even ace bowlers of his era was here batting for them. When reminded of the irony, he was quick to claim, "I got a reasonable amount of wickets; so I would want to consider myself a bowler..."

The topics he touched upon were relevant. And his views on them not just educated the audience, but also put the spotlight on aspects of the game that need immediate intervention. Explaining how the T20s and ODIs are heavily loaded in favour of the batters, Sachin supported the idea to incentivise bowlers. Maintaining that the trend of Test matches ending



Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH